

Vote of Confidence

It seems the entire political system is hell bent on denigrating Gujarat Chief Minister Narendra Modi ("Taking on Goliath", December 10). The reason for this may be his stubbornness, good governance, development-oriented administration and above all, his ability to unite the Hindu voters.

V.S. GANESHAN, *Bangalore*

Modi has two challenges to face: the Opposition which has been hitting him below the belt and, the media which has been blowing issues out of proportion. But this propaganda will only help BJP win more seats.

ADITYA RATHI, *on e-mail*

Whatever may be the credentials of the person going to take on Modi in the upcoming elections, it will be an uphill task to defeat the chief minister. His excellent oratory skills and brilliant organisational ability make him a tough nut to crack.

V.K. NAIR, *Mumbai*

Insatiable Hunger

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister M. Karunanidhi has only himself to blame for all his problems ("Transition Troubles", December 10). He won't pass the baton on to anybody since his love for power is well known.

G. RAMACHANDRAN,
Thiruvananthapuram

Misleading Claims

Though the attack on the Adivasi woman was inhuman, terms such as "helpless Adivasis" or "growing intolerance"

are exaggerated ("Insult to Injury", December 10). It is time we realised that not all tribals are marginalised. In the North-east a large section of the population is tribal and enjoys constitutional protection.

MEGHANA., *Hyderabad*

The death toll in the November 24 incident is only one and not seven as reported in the magazine. In fact, the incident has been blown out of proportion by a

section of the media.

DEBA KUMAR BORA,
Press Adviser to Assam Chief Minister, Guwahati

Not an Accused

In Signposts (November 27), you have wrongly stated that the R.S. Pathak panel, which probed the UN oil-for-food scam, had accused me of being involved in it. The former chief justice had given me a clean chit in this case.

K. NATWAR SINGH
Member of Parliament

COUNTRY'S BEST BET



The issue showcased India truly at its best ("Best of India", November 26). From the simple to the sublime, the country is blessed with a raw beauty and vitality that no nation can ever match. One is proud to be born in such a country.

PRASHANTH KUMAR, *Ohio, USA*

The treasures selected by the magazine were elitist and beyond the reach of most Indians. To call it diverse and affordable is erroneous. The list should have included at least some places that are within the reach of the common man.

A.R. MAHENDRA, *Hyderabad*

There was no way in which the issue could have been called the Best of India since only one of the "best" sites was located in the eastern part of the country.

ANANDA LAL, *Kolkata*

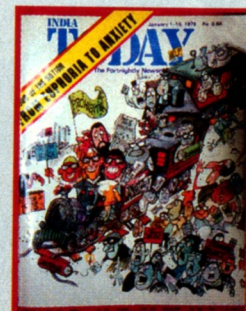
Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquiries before sending money, incurring expenses or entering into commitments in relation to any advertisement appearing in this publication. The India Today Group does not vouch for any claims made by the advertisers of products and services. The printer, publisher, editor-in-chief and the editor of the India Today Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences in the event of such claims not being honoured by the advertisers.

e-mail your letters to: letters.editor@intoday.com
or fax them to: 011-23316180

30

Years Ago in India Today

JANUARY 1-15, 1978



Red Carpet for Carter

All of a sudden half the world seems to be beating on India's front door. The Shah of Iran, the Secretary-General of the Commonwealth, the British Prime Minister—and, perhaps more spectacularly than any of the foregoing, President Jimmy Carter. So Palam's red carpet is going threadbare, the men at ministries are showing signs of premature old age—and



Carter and the foreign leaders are leaving after a few days of courtesies, finding India as enigmatic a place as ever. Without any doubt that is just how Carter will feel when Air Force One soars into the western skies, bound for the safe familiarity of the White House. For though Carter and Morarji Desai share some outward similarities—their aversion to drink, to sexual excess—they are more miles apart in their political, spiritual and philosophical approaches than lie between the two capitals over which they hold sway.

—Simon Winchester

FOR SUBSCRIPTION ASSISTANCE CALL: (95120) 2479900 from DELHI and FARIDABAD; (0120) 2479900 from REST OF INDIA; Fax (0120) 4078080 KOLKATA: Tel 22821922, 22827726, 22825398 Fax 22825398, 22827254 BANGALORE: Tel 2212448, 2290562, 2218343 Fax 2218335 MUMBAI: Tel 24444423/4/5/6 Fax 24444358 CHENNAI: Tel 28478525-44 Fax 28472178. FOR CUSTOMER CARE CALL: 1800 1800 100 (from BSNL/MTNL lines) 120 2479900 (Monday–Friday; 10am–6 pm); WRITE IN: WE CARE, The India Today Group, A-61, Sector-57, Noida (U.P.)-201301. e-mail: wecare@intoday.com